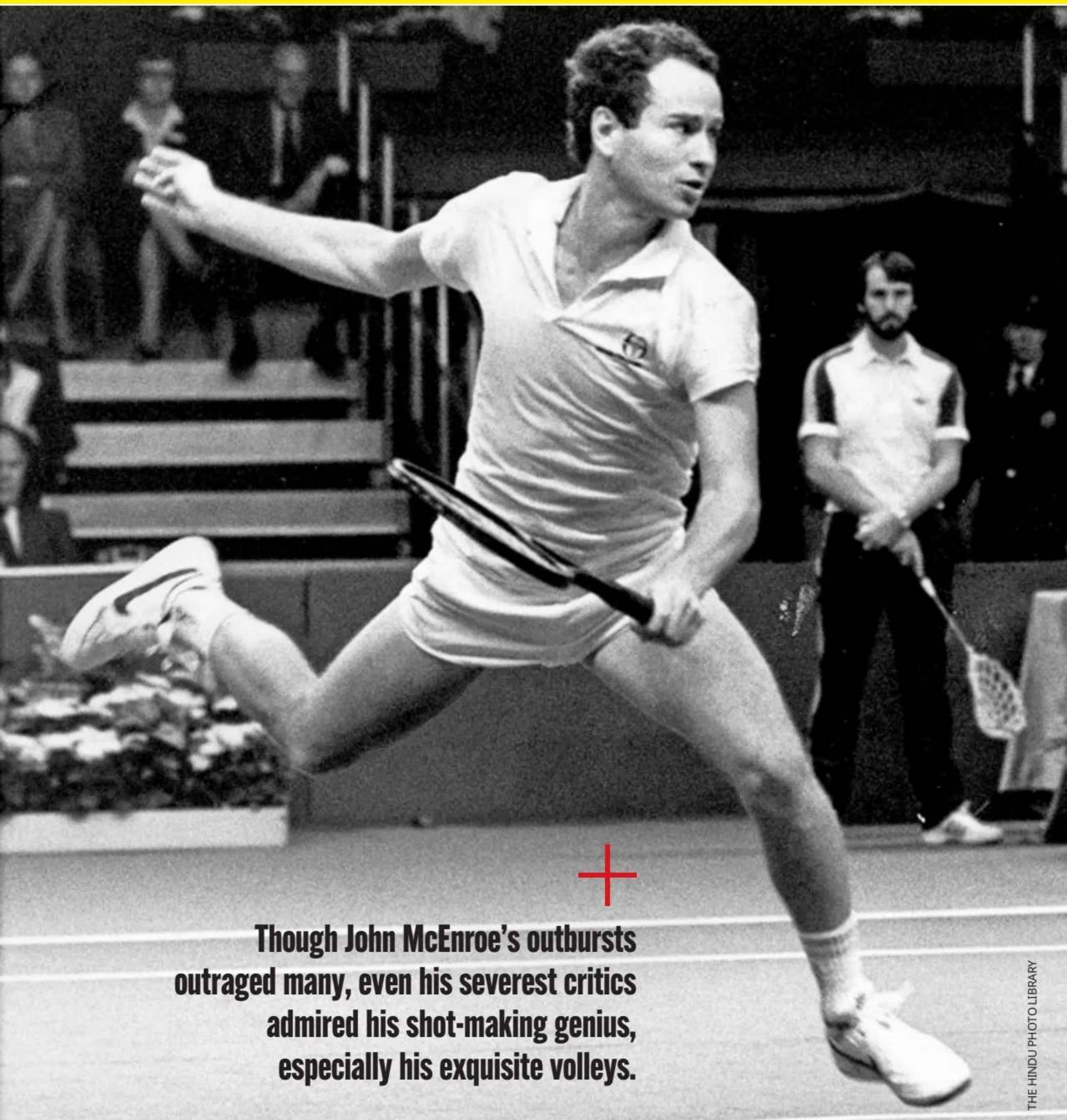




Though John McEnroe's outbursts outraged many, even his severest critics admired his shot-making genius, especially his exquisite volleys.

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days was being called an artist. Though his outbursts outraged many, even his severest critics admired his shot-making genius, especially his exquisite volleys. "In terms of tennis talent, I've never seen anyone better than John," Ashe once said.

McEnroe captured four US Open and three Wimbledon titles, but he

undoubtedly could have won more majors. He was fuelled by a rage for perfection, a Vesuvian rage that could explode at any time and often targeted lines people and umpires. "I want to change. I gotta change. I don't want to be some maniac," he confided in 1981.

Clay was McEnroe's least effective surface, and the French Open

failures left a glaring gap in his resume. In 1984, after he outclassed Connors 7-5, 6-1, 6-2 in the semifinals, he again looked unstoppable against 24-year-old Lendl in the first two sets, allowing only 10 points in his nine service games. McEnroe tormented and bewildered his mechanical foe with vicious lefty serves, stinging volleys,